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r/GooglePixel • 4mo ago
2fast4blue

Got my Pixel 10 and it is great but...

I honestly love the experience so far, everythink is going fine amd the phone feels truly great. Nothing to complain actually but one small thing that actually annoys me a lot.

Why can't you switch between selfie camera and the main camera during video???

Like wtf why not? My old phone from 2019 could do this, obviously like... why don't they allow it?

Is there any setting I am missing?

lmk

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Usual_Vermicelli_961 • 4mo ago

It's really funny how Pixels went to top of the camera game to really slacking in user experience and quality. The video of the phone really disappointed me, and Pro Res zoom.. I hate it. But I hope Google got the memo that they need to fix these camera issues and it's hardware for their next phone :)

29 Reply ···

Micromize • 4mo ago

This was only the case for photos. Videos were never the strong point....

6 Reply ···

whispy_snippet • 4mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

Look up 12 bit DCG RAW on the Pixel 10 Pro. It can shoot higher quality video than even the iPhone 17 Pro using ProRes RAW. ProRes is a lossy compression format whereas the Pixel 10 Pro can shoot in genuine RAW, and at 12 bit, using an entirely unique sensor technology. There's plenty of examples of this on YouTube now that people have discovered this: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YVj6JYXF14M&t=295s

To be clear, this isn't the sort of thing every day consumers would want to bother with. RAW takes up enormous amounts of storage space and generally requires professional editing software to grade - but then the same largely applies for Apple's ProRes RAW. The simple fact of the matter is that every day users wouldn't be able to tell the difference between regular video shot on a Pixel or an iPhone.

Why do you hate ProRes zoom? It's absolutely unbelievable and one of its best features.

Usual_Vermicelli_961 • 4mo ago

Because it's not real, I have had instances where you could clearly see it's jsut randomly making stuff up. Even got a random American Eagle in the trees. It takes the believability away. I don't need any A.i. assitance. I want my camera to just look good by having good hardware not by having a computer guess how things look. Looking at my Samsung or iPhone this really feels lackluster and very not Google.

whispy_snippet • 4mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

If you're getting a random eagle then you're honestly not using ProRes zoom within its performance envelope. You're shooting things way too far away.

There's a strong argument to be had that Google's "ProRes" zoom, when used as intended, is no more fake than regular digital zoom. If you do a side by side comparison of two images of a distant subject (one taken using Google's new AI zoom and the other using conventional digital zoom), one looks relatively crisp and sharp and the other looks artefacty and noisy. One looks closer to reality than the other, even if neither are a completely accurate rendition of the subject.

Is zoom that digitally magnifies images (that introduces noise and artefacts that are not present in reality, smears detail, and can make text unreadable) actually no better than AI augmented zoom? You could just as easily make the case that digital zoom is artificial as well. It's just using different technology to achieve the same objective.

I was recently in Fiji and wanted to test ProRes zoom extensively. Look at these examples:

https://imgur.com/a/3BeQBxu

https://imgur.com/a/fhUfXLL

https://imgur.com/a/x1eLmal

The improvement in sharpness and detail from ProRes zoom in undeniable. Now I say this with full knowledge that some of this is approximating to some level - but again, I would argue that digital zoom is also a tool that artificially enhances imagery of distant subjects. The grain/noise you see in digitally zoomed images is the sensor ramping up the ISO to accommodate for low exposure and high shutter speeds and therefore amplifying noise. In other words, *you are seeing something that wasn't really visible to the human eye in the first place.*

And what about post processing? Photoshop and Lightroom have existed for years where people tweak colour, clarity, sharpness, remove zits, clear up whiteness in people's eyes, make skies bluer, make grass greener, and apply all sorts of filters and photo styles. You can even do this within smartphones themselves from Android *and* iOS. Is this any better? And what about smartphone "portrait mode" that artificially blurs backgrounds? What about long exposure photography? What about bokeh? What about black and white imagery? Is any of this "real"?

None of this is to say that ProRes zoom is perfect. But I think where this tech falls over is in the hands of people who perhaps don't seem to understand its limitations. It's not a tool to make things that are impossible to see possible to see. It's not there to make bad shots good. It's to make good shots better. It improves detail of things you can already see. If you're getting bad results you are simply shooting things too far away. It's not to pick out a bird in a tree from a kilometre away. It's to improve the detail of a bird 30 metres away. It's not a sniper scope.

Usual_Vermicelli_961 • 4mo ago

Bruh, I feel you on fake bokeh and portrait mode, but that's not the same thing as ProRes Zoom on the Pixel 10 Pro. Portrait mode blur? That's just working with the data the sensor actually captured. It's all real info, you're just tweaking it.

ProRes Zoom? That's straight-up AI making stuff up. Textures, shapes, tiny details, it can invent things that were never there. (look at your parasailing picture where it's inventing new wires that are not visible in your original picture) It's not "enhancing" reality, it's guessing at it. Saying that's the same as fake blur or post-processing is just wrong. One is refining reality, the other is fabricating it.

All of this A.i. bs is not necessary they could have just added better camera lenses like Apple and Samsung did, here's clear example of how bad the camera lens of the Pixel is. They purposfully did that so it relies on A.i. to fill in the gaps. If it had a better lens we would not have A.i. slop to rely on for the camera. Which is also the reason why it's video quality also is so low and needs to be boosted in the cloud for 6 hours to create the same effects Iphone and Galaxy phones can do ON DEVICE.

If you care about actual photography and what the camera really saw, Pixel 10 Pro's AI zoom isn't "real" in the traditional sense. It might look cool, but it's not capturing truth, it's making an educated guess at it. That's where I have a problem, it's not necessary.

whispy_snippet • 4mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

But it hasn't invented - there are wires there even in the original (I'm not sure if you're viewing the images on a phone screen but if you look on a computer monitor you can see there are wires there). What looks more "real"? A shot where the wires are invisible (which isn't real - wires are visible to human vision) or a shot where the wires *are* visible (which is arguably more realistic)? Yes, I appreciate it may not look *exactly* like the wires if you and I were standing right next to them. But equally, if we were standing right next to them the wires wouldn't be invisible either. So neither is a one-to-one mirror of reality. Both are approximations using different technologies.

Bokeh and portrait blur is *exactly* the same. Blur does not exist in our reality. It's not refining, it's fabricating. We don't look at people's faces in day to day and see a blurred out background behind them. This is not a representation of reality. It's not real. With typical mirrorless/DSLR type cameras it's a product of aperture, with smartphones it's a process of computational forgery. It's fake. *Both* traditional bokeh and smartphone portrait mode blur is not "real". It's an aesthetic choice through the

What you're not acknowledging is that unless you want to start making phones meaningfully thicker (like they do in non Western markets of the world) smartphone imagery is starting to hit a wall in terms of imaging. That video you linked to is shady as. Who is it from? The guy has three subscribers and we have no idea who it is. We have no voice over, no indication of what settings are being used, we don't know whether the clips have been modified, and we don't know for certain if that's even the Pro XL or just the regular 10 (or something even older). I have nfi why that looks like total potato (not to mention it's only the viewfinder, not the final video output) but my 10 Pro video looks absolutely nothing like that. I wouldn't be trusting that video as a true and fair representation at all. The zoom lens on the Pixel 10 Pro is a native 113mm equivalent and has a longer focal length than the iPhone 17 Pro's 100mm equivalent telephoto. And yeah, processing obviously plays a big part as well but there is something off in that example. Whatever is going on in that video is fucking bogus. Go and watch some videos of trusted imaging reviewers on YouTube. I don't trust that clip at all.

It's also incorrect that the Pixel is using "AI to fill in the gaps". There is no AI used through the viewfinder, nor is there AI used in real time video recording. The *only* time AI is used is when you go beyond 30x zoom on the Pro line in photo mode, and then hit the shutter button. It then processes a still image using ProRes zoom.

I'd also contest what you say about video. The Pixel 10 Pro's video boost upscales (up to 8K) and applies a level of processing in the cloud that is beyond what competing smartphones do straight out of camera. It significantly reduces noise, improves stabilisation, and improves exposure levels. And if you want professional grade footage, the Pixel 10 Pro is the only phone that supports 12 bit DCG RAW resulting in significantly better image quality than what Apple and Samsung can output (which I linked to earlier). This isn't to say it's a straight out win for the Pixel, but I think you're omitting a lot of nuance to this debate.

But I digress. I'm not trying to say ProRes zoom is the greatest thing since sliced bread. But what I will contest is the position that ProRes zoom isn't any less real than over a century of techniques and technologies aimed at improving imagery for various ends - from dodging and burning in dark rooms, to long exposure photography, to different film stocks, to bokeh, to digital zoom, and to computer editing techniques and software. If you say ProRes zoom isn't real then you must acknowledge that many, many aspects of photography are also not real as well. You can't be selective on what is and isn't real.

Usual_Vermicelli_961 • 4mo ago

No offence but all I'm reading is someone whos glazing A.i. slop like no other. This is NOT the route Google should be going point blank period. Here's the link to the original creator who's footage you "don't trust" and call "bogus" watch the entire video, in fact watch it on your monitor. And judge for yourself. This guy is the biggest and trusted YouTuber when it comes to comparing Smartphone videos. Google IS lacking behind it's competitors. Look at this topic look at the last slide and compare to the middle one. You called this the best thing since sliced bread I call this absolute garbage. Fully creating false bs. This entire discusion made me

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whispy_snippet • 4mo ago

Also confirmed that in the video you shared the Pixel 10 Pro wasn't even using the telephoto lens in that zoom example, it was a software bug that was cropping from the main sensor. The video maker even acknowledged it.

https://imgur.com/a/pZewans

That would explain why it looked like hot garbage and absolutely nothing like what I have experienced.

whispy_snippet • 4mo ago

Firstly, I didn't call it the best thing since sliced bread. I said the opposite. And second, thanks for the link. Yep that's a decent video but watching the whole thing paints a far more balanced picture than the tiny little segment you originally shared. In multiple instances the Pixel did a better job and it also showed that its boosted video is often superior to what Apple and Samsung can do straight out of camera. Not in every instance of course. And I don't disagree that it would be preferable for all processing to happen on-device. But it's also obvious that some of this processing is just too computationally intensive for any of the three major players to pull off in real time without cooking the SoC or killing the battery. The iPhone doesn't even do 8K at all, for example, and Samsung continues to have focus issues which have been plaguing their cameras for years now. But again, going back to my earlier post, take a look at what the Pixel 10 Pro can do with 12 bit DCG RAW. It can record higher quality pro grade video footage than anything Apple or Samsung can currently achieve: https://youtu.be/YVj6JYXF14M?si=GLhf72LXlQca81ud

The eagle example you showed is pretty funny but it literally highlights my original point that some people are trying to use ProRes zoom on things too far away. Look at my examples compared to the example you shared - there's no absurd hallucination going on in my images because I'm not trying to shoot things beyond ProRes Zoom's limitations.

Personally I think Google is making good strides. 12 bit DCG RAW allows for industry leading pro grade smartphone video quality, and video boost uploads will be used to develop algorithms to allow on device processing in the future. In the meantime we get to see some innovation that is pushing mobile photography and video forward (remember computational photography - that's multi frame image stacking - was pioneered by Google and is now a mainstream feature in pretty much every smartphone). The same goes for ProRes zoom - others will need to respond because it's an impressive piece of imaging technology when used appropriately.

kenkiller • 4mo ago

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AapChutiyaHai • 4mo ago

The other day I was recording video and normally I'm not watching the screen but a message popped up saying "reducing resolution to improve stabilization" or something like that.

I was like wtf. Samsung doesn't do this. Neither does iPhone.

Why.. why is video so hard for these clowns to get right.

WackyBeachJustice • 4mo ago
Pixel 9a

Probably because they aren't really trying.

abucketofpuppies • 4mo ago

Did it have a noticeable decrease in fidelity? Or did it just crop the image a bit?

RedditLifter • 3mo ago

Turn off the setting for this then?

StimulatorCam • 4mo ago
Pixel 8 Pro Top 1% Commenter

It just doesn't exist in the stock camera app for whatever reason.

KobePit48 • 4mo ago

nemomnis • 4mo ago

As a new owner of a Pixel 10 Pro (coming from a Huawei), I'm extremely disappointed by the battery (it really sucks) and the build quality (apparently one of my camera lenses has to be fixed because it's skewed!)

Wet-Flatulence • 4mo ago

This is just a Pixel 10 issue? I just tried my pixel 8 and during video I am able to switch to front face camera

Dull-Fox1401 • 3mo ago

Pretty_Professor_828 • 3mo ago

How is the battery life?

mlemmers1234 • 4mo ago

Probably just something that they haven't thought to add into their stock camera application.

Micromize • 4mo ago

It is because the pixel is a relatively young brand and for features, they rather focus on quality than quantity. The first pixel is from 2016, while the first Samsung is from 2009.

That is 7 years extra of development time and Samsung is just putting out as many features as possible. Plus video has never been a focus for the pixel line up. The point you are making can be said for every pixel release.

takeoo111111 • 4mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

Before Pixel there was the Nexus Series. The first came out in 2010

Micromize • 4mo ago

Yes but those are two different things. Nexus devices were not manufactured by Google. Google just did their 'minimal' software part, very much focussed on the tech enthusiasts. And at the same time maintaining Android, that was their focus. With the pixel line up they started to create and expand their own branding, hardware, software and marketing for the masses.

KobePit48 • 4mo ago

mrbe_007 • 2mo ago

looking forward to it